5E LESSON PLAN: WEEK 2 – MISS PATTERSON

- **Institution:** Happy Grove High School
- **Grade Level:** Grade 8
- **Class:** 8^3
- **Subject:** English Literature
- **Date:** September 14, 2026
- **Duration:** 60 minutes
- **NSC Learning Strand:** Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature)
- **NSC Attainment Target:** Students will read for meaning, identify structural/language choices made by authors, and use text evidence to critically respond to literature.
- **Topic:** Introduction to Novel Setting and Atmosphere (My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson by C. Everard Palmer)
- **Previous Knowledge:** Week 1 introduced the class and gave an overview of the novel My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson. Students know that every story has characters and a place where it happens.

Key Vocabulary

Key Vocabulary (word wall)

Setting: the time and place in which a story happens

Atmosphere: the mood or feeling a place creates for the reader and the characters

Mood: a feeling, such as gloomy, peaceful, tense or joyful

Sensory details: words that appeal to the five senses

Evidence: words or details from the text that prove a point

Contrast: show how two things are different

Learning Objectives

By the end of the lesson:

Cognitive

1. After the class discussion, students will define setting and atmosphere in their own words, giving one example of each from Chapter 1.
2. Using a two-column chart, students will contrast the physical features and moods of Robin Hill and River Bottom, supporting at least three points of difference with evidence from Chapter 1.

Affective

3. While working in mixed-ability reading pairs, students will share the reading, with each partner reading aloud at least once.

Psychomotor

4. Using the Evidence Strips, students will sort descriptions onto the correct side of the Robin Hill vs. River Bottom T-chart, placing at least four of five strips correctly.

Learning Domains

- **Cognitive:** Define setting/atmosphere; analyse text details; contrast two settings using evidence.
- **Affective:** Value peer perspectives during paired reading; show confidence when sharing interpretations.
- **Psychomotor:** Sort and place Evidence Strips onto a graphic organizer.

Learning Styles

- **Visual:** Graphic organizers and the contrasting boxes on the whiteboard.
- **Auditory:** Teacher read-aloud, peer discussion, whole-class sharing.
- **Kinaesthetic:** Sorting and placing Evidence Strips on the T-chart.

Resources

- Class copies of Chapter 1 of My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson
- Environment boxes (in Engage below)
- Draft sheet and pair role slips (in Explore below)
- Envelopes with printed Evidence Strips and chart paper for the T-chart (in Elaborate below)
- KWL charts and exit tickets (one per student)
- PowerPoint and whiteboard

NSC Major Objectives (Curriculum Alignment)

- Compare and contrast the elements and authors of various literary genres (e.g. short story, novel, drama, fable, fantasy, biography, documentary, poetry, and science-fiction). *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 1, Unit 1). Checked by: Exit Ticket Q1 (setting as an element of the novel).*
- Determine a central idea of a text and analyse its development over the course of the text, including its relationship to supporting ideas. *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 1, Unit 1). Checked by: Exit Ticket Q2–3 and the homework paragraph (how setting shapes atmosphere).*

Instructional Strategies

- **KWL Chart:** Engage – what students know and want to know about where stories happen.
- **Concept Mapping:** Engage – the class builds a mood-word concept map from the two environment boxes.
- **Think-Pair-Share:** Engage – pairs discuss how each environment would make them feel before sharing with the class.
- **Paired (Buddy) Reading with Role Slips:** Explore – mixed-ability pairs take turns reading Chapter 1 aloud.
- **Text Annotation (underlining):** Explore – pairs underline sensory words for Robin Hill and River Bottom.
- **Teacher Modelling (I do, We do, You do):** Explain – the teacher models row 1 of the setting-to-atmosphere table; a student completes row 2.

- **Higher-Order Questioning:** Explain – analyse, compare, evaluate and create questions.
- **Card Sort:** Elaborate – pairs sort Evidence Strips onto the T-chart.
- **Differentiated Instruction:** Elaborate – sentence frames for the support tier; analytical paragraph for the extension tier.
- **Peer Assessment (Star and Wish):** Elaborate – pairs check another pair's T-chart.
- **Traffic-Light Self-Assessment and Exit Ticket:** Evaluate – individual check on setting and atmosphere.

Subject Integration

- **Geography (Explain):** Students name a real place in Jamaica that looks like Robin Hill (hills) or River Bottom (a river valley) and say what mood that place gives them.
- **Visual Arts (Elaborate):** When the T-chart is done, pairs name one colour for Robin Hill and one for River Bottom and explain how each colour matches the mood.

Classroom Organization and Management

- **Classroom layout and safety:** Desks are arranged in mixed-ability pairs facing the whiteboard, with space on the side wall for the T-charts. Bags hang on the backs of chairs and walkways are kept clear so the teacher can reach every group.
- **Materials:** Cards, strips and worksheets are prepared in labelled envelopes before the lesson, so no time is lost handing them out.
- **Group roles:** For group tasks, each member receives a role slip (see the slips in the procedure) so every student knows exactly what to do and no one is left out.
- **Transitions:** The teacher uses the call-and-response "Class, class!" / "Yes, yes!" as an attention signal, and a visible timer shows how long each phase lasts.
- **Positive reinforcement:** Specific verbal praise, group points on the board, and good work displayed on the word wall.
- **Expectations:** Listen when others speak, respect every answer, share tasks fairly, and handle materials carefully.

Accommodations (Inclusion)

- **Reading difficulties:** Large-print cards and a reading partner; the teacher reads text aloud on request.
- **Writing difficulties:** Students may answer orally, point to the correct card, or have a peer scribe one answer.
- **Attention or vision needs:** Preferential seating near the board and the teacher.
- **Absent students:** Students who miss the lesson (for example, for sports) receive the notes and classwork as a catch-up pack.

Backup Plan (No Technology)

- **If there is no electricity, internet or projector:** The two environment boxes and the definitions are written on the whiteboard; the draft sheets and Evidence Strips are printed.

5E PROCEDURE

1. ENGAGEMENT (10 minutes)

- **Activating Prior Knowledge:** Students fill in the K and W columns of their KWL chart about where stories happen. The teacher asks: "From our overview last week, where does the novel take place? What do you already know about Sun-Sun Johnson?"

KWL Chart: Where Stories Happen (one per student)

K – What I Know	W – What I Want to Know	L – What I Learned
e.g. A story happens in a place.	*e.g. How does a place make us feel?*	*(Completed in Evaluate)*

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will analyse two contrasting environment boxes written on the board. In pairs, students debate how their mood would shift in each environment and call out descriptive emotional keywords (e.g. "sad", "happy", "trapped") to build a class concept map.

Environment Boxes

Box A	Box B
"Bright, spacious, filled with laughter"	"Dark, cramped, cold rain outside"
Mood keywords: _____	Mood keywords: _____

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will display the contrasting boxes, record students' keywords on the board, and assess students' baseline ability to connect physical details to moods. The teacher will ask:
- How would you feel if you were in Box A? In Box B?
- Which words in each box made you feel that way?
- Did the place change, or did your feelings change? (Lead students to see that the place shapes the mood.)
- **Technology (in class):** The two boxes are shown on a PowerPoint slide; the class concept map is built on the whiteboard.
- **Formative Check:** Each pair calls out one mood word for each box; the teacher notes pairs who cannot yet link a place to a mood.

(Visual & Auditory)

2. EXPLORATION (15 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will work in assigned, mixed-ability pairs and take turns reading Chapter 1 and the first page of Chapter 2 (page 15) aloud. Using their pens, pairs underline sensory words that show what can be seen, heard or felt at Robin Hill and River Bottom, and log their findings on the draft sheet.

Draft Sheet (one per pair)

Sense	Robin Hill	River Bottom
What can be seen		
What can be heard		
What can be felt		

Pair Role Slips (swap after each page) (cut out; give one slip to each group member)

✂️ **Reader**
Read the page aloud clearly to your partner.

✂️ **Recorder**
Underline the sensory words and write them on the draft sheet under the right place.

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will hand out Chapter 1 and circulate to give vocabulary support to pairs who struggle with the text. The teacher will ask: "What does this word let you see, hear or feel?" and "Is this at Robin Hill or River Bottom?"
- **Formative Check:** The teacher checks that each pair has at least one word in each row for both places.
- **Feedback:** The teacher gives specific feedback, e.g. "Good – 'the bush was all around us' is something you can see. Which column does it belong in?"

(Auditory & Kinaesthetic)

3. EXPLANATION (10 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will use their findings to form working definitions of setting and atmosphere and copy them into their notebooks. Volunteers show how a physical detail (e.g. Robin Hill's grand house) creates a mood (e.g. luxury and pride), and explain how losing this setting changes Sun-Sun's whole world.

Key Definitions (students copy into notebooks)

Setting: the time and place in which a story happens, including the physical surroundings (e.g. Robin Hill, River Bottom, the village square).

Atmosphere: the mood or feeling a place creates for the reader and the characters (e.g. gloomy, peaceful, tense, joyful).

Sensory details: words that appeal to the five senses (sight, sound, touch, taste, smell) and help create the atmosphere.

Model: Linking Setting to Atmosphere

Physical detail (setting)	Mood created (atmosphere)	Why?
Robin Hill's grand house	Luxury and pride	The family once had wealth and status there.

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will write the definitions on the board, guide the link between physical settings and mood, and model the first row of the table. A student volunteer then completes the second row using a detail from their draft sheet.

Higher-Order Questions (whole-class discussion)

1. Analyse: Why does Robin Hill feel gloomy after the family loses it?
2. Compare: How is the atmosphere at River Bottom different from the atmosphere at Robin Hill?
3. Evaluate: Is River Bottom a worse place to live than Robin Hill? Justify your answer with evidence.
4. Create: Write one sentence describing our classroom so that it creates a happy atmosphere.

Guide answers: the loss brings sadness ("We did not even light the gas lamps"); River Bottom is close to nature and simple but hopeful, while Robin Hill now feels bitter; accept a reasoned answer supported by Chapter 1; accept any sentence with clear sensory details.

- **Subject Integration (Geography):** Students name a real place in Jamaica that looks like Robin Hill (hills) or River Bottom (a river valley) and say what mood that place gives them.
- **Technology (in class):** The definitions and the model table are shown on a PowerPoint slide.
- **Formative Check:** Thumbs up or down: "Atmosphere is the time and place of a story." (Thumbs down – that is setting.)

(Visual & Auditory)

4. ELABORATION (15 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will work with their reading partner to sort the Evidence Strips from their envelopes, placing each description under the correct column of a large Robin Hill vs. River Bottom T-chart.

T-Chart (on chart paper)

Robin Hill	River Bottom

Pair Role Slips (cut out; give one slip to each group member)

✂️ **Sorter**
Read each strip aloud and decide with your partner which place it describes.

✂️ **Checker**
Check the strip against Chapter 1 before it goes on the chart.

- **Differentiation Support:** Supported pairs sort strips with the key words already underlined, using the frame: "River Bottom feels _____ because the text describes it as _____."
- **Differentiation Extension:** Extended pairs write an analytical paragraph showing how the decay of the setting mirrors Sun-Sun's emotional crisis.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will hand out the envelopes, monitor the pairs, and check that each strip matches its column.

Teacher's Example Key (text evidence)

Robin Hill (Chapter 1, page 11)	River Bottom (start of Chapter 2, page 15)
"We did not even light the gas lamps." – gloom, sadness after the loss	"The bush was all around us and I was belly-to-belly with Nature" – closeness to nature, peace
"The food was like bad medicine and the laughter mockery." – bitterness, humiliation	"We didn't have running water and never would but we would be comfortable." – simple, hard but hopeful

- **Subject Integration (Visual Arts):** Pairs name one colour for Robin Hill and one for River Bottom and explain how each colour matches the mood.
- **Numeracy Link:** Pairs count how many strips they placed on each side and write each as a fraction of all the strips (e.g. 3 out of 5 for River Bottom).
- **Peer Assessment:** Pairs swap with the pair beside them, check the T-chart against the text, and give one star and one wish.
- **Feedback:** The teacher praises pairs who explained their choices with evidence and corrects any strip in the wrong column.

(Kinaesthetic & Visual)

5. EVALUATION (10 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will complete the exit ticket on their own, without notes or help, then fill in the L column of the KWL chart and the traffic-light self-assessment.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will collect the T-charts, make sure students complete the exit ticket on their own, and collect the exit tickets at the end of the 10 minutes.

Exit Ticket

1. Define setting in your own words.
2. Give one physical detail used to describe River Bottom (end of Chapter 1 or start of Chapter 2).
3. What kind of atmosphere does that detail create for Sun-Sun and Rami?

Teacher Answers: Exit Ticket

1. The time and place in which a story happens. 2. e.g. "The bush was all around us"; no running water. 3. e.g. peaceful and close to nature; simple, hard but hopeful.

- **Self-Assessment:** Students rate each statement with a traffic light.

Traffic-Light Self-Assessment (students tick one colour for each statement)

I can…	Green	Yellow	Red
define setting and atmosphere	☐	☐	☐
find details that describe a place	☐	☐	☐
explain the mood a place creates	☐	☐	☐

Green = I can do this on my own. Yellow = I need a little more practice. Red = I need help.

- **Closure:** One student completes the sentence aloud: "The setting of a story can make us feel…"
- **Positive Reinforcement:** The teacher praises pairs who read and worked well together and awards class points.

(Visual & Auditory)

Total: 10 + 15 + 10 + 15 + 10 = 60 minutes

Homework / Extension Assignment

In your literature notebook, select either Robin Hill or River Bottom. Write a 5-sentence paragraph describing a real or imaginary place you have visited that has a similar atmosphere or mood. Cite at least two specific words from Chapter 1 to justify the comparison.

Technology Integration (Homework & Practice)

- **Google Classroom:** Post a copy of Chapter 1 and the homework instructions. Students submit their 5-sentence paragraph on Google Classroom.
- **Quizizz:** Assign a short practice quiz (8–10 questions) on setting, atmosphere and Chapter 1 details, to be completed at home.

Assessment Summary

Type	What is assessed
Diagnostic	KWL chart (K and W); mood keywords during Engage.
Formative	Pair reading and draft sheets; T-chart with peer feedback; Quizizz practice report.
Summative	Exit ticket; homework descriptive paragraph.

Success Criteria

Students are successful when they can accurately match at least two text descriptions to the correct location and express the emotional impact of those settings in writing.

Link to Previous and Next Lesson

- **Previous:** Week 1 – Introduction to the class and an overview of the novel.
- **Next:** Week 3 – Characterization: external traits in Chapters 2 and 3.

APA References

- Ministry of Education, Youth and Information. (2018). *National Standards Curriculum: Language and Literature Grades 7–9*. Kingston, Jamaica: MoEYI.
- Ministry of Education, Skills, Youth and Information. (n.d.). *Curriculum analysis: Essential objectives & content focus – NSC Grades 7–9* (2nd ed.). Kingston, Jamaica.
- Bybee, R. W., & Landes, N. M. (1990). Science for life and living: An elementary school science program from Biological Sciences Curriculum Study. *The American Biology Teacher, 52*(2), 92–98.
- Palmer, C. E. (1974). *My father, Sun-Sun Johnson*. Macmillan Caribbean.

Lesson Evaluation (complete after teaching)

What went well:

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_____

What to improve:

_____

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Students who need follow-up: